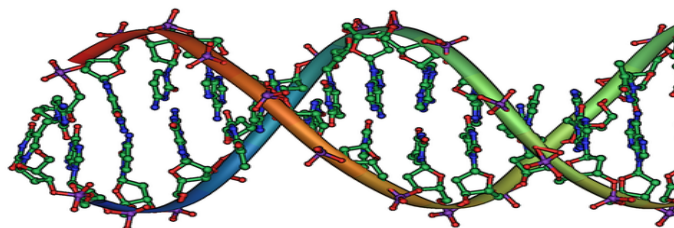


# Improvement of diagnostics of quarantine pathogens by digital PCR (QUASAR)



## Funding

Non-competitive funding mechanism. Each funder only pays for the participation of their own national researchers. Total funding € 156 000

## Research consortium

NIB (SI), AGES (AT), VSUO (CZ), ANSES (FR), DAFM (IE), CREA (IT), SASA (GB), APHIS (USDA), UNIBO (IT), UOA (PT), BEJO (NL),

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## Goals

The project aims to assess and demonstrate the suitability of digital PCR for (i) detection and quantification of selected target organisms in difficult samples of plants, vectors or environmental samples, and (ii) characterization of in-house prepared control materials.

## Objectives and key outputs

The collaboration will enable exchange of experience, data and increased awareness of the potential benefits of the digital PCR approach.

Data on the current use and experience of dPCR, will be collected and linked to literature reports, will allow to (i) identify potential data gaps and synergies among partner, and (ii) develop guidelines on good practice facilitating a harmonized approach to the use of dPCR. A list of matrices successfully tested will also be generated. An update will be proposed of EPPO PM 7/98 tables giving detailed guidance for the validation and verification process of digital PCR by fields.

A small-scale interlaboratory study will be organized to examine the robustness of different approaches to assigning reference values. Participants will analyze samples and report on the assigned values (concentrations).

Based on the results, critical points will be identified in calculating the reference values and their relation to biological units, and recommendation on how to assign values to control samples will be made.